enthronement, another equally strong cabal threw its weight behind her trifling (but male) brother Firoz ("a weak and licentious prince"). Raziyya claimed and held on to the title *Sultan*, but she found herself continually thwarted not just by her Hindu enemies, but by the subjects in her own sultanate who did not acknowledge her sovereignty. She was, according to all accounts, a competent, clear-thinking, strategic ruler, but even her attempts to prove her worth by wearing male clothing and armor threw the Sultanate of Delhi into a long and violent chaos. Raziyya, would-be defender of Islam, threatened Delhi's very existence as an Islamic state; and it was, almost, unable to survive the contradiction.[12]

